

The Ultimate Organiser for the Console Junkie

Introducing Calcurse, a text-based organiser that can work as your personal assistant.



*H*ave you ever forgotten an important meeting? Or missed the latest episode of *Lost*? I'm sure it's happened to some of you.

Juggling tasks is difficult, so instead of trying to keep track of every important thing either in your head or on a piece of paper, why not give computer-based organisers a try? There are many organiser applications available on the Linux platform, and they're called Personal Information Managers (PIM). People are mostly familiar with Korganizer and Sunbird as power-packed PIMs. They are very good, no doubt, but are not the only good applications available in the open source world.

Graphical tools, though intuitive, are often resource hungry. I am sure many of us would prefer solutions with much less resource requirements, yet with an easy and intuitive interface. This is where Calcurse comes into the picture. Calcurse is a text-based calendar and scheduling program with loads of features. The name Calcurse is derived from 'calendar + ncurses'. You guessed right; it has an ncurses-based interface—which makes it very easy to use.

What is Calcurse?

By using Calcurse you can keep track of your daily tasks, appointments and events. You can also set notifications to tasks, as and when required, and sort the tasks by priority. You can even tag the entries with notes. There is an option to change the colour scheme, change the layout and also change the key-bindings right from the application itself. You don't even need to edit the configuration files externally, manually. With many additional features like the import and export of the iCal format calendar (Google calendar uses this), auto-save, the ability to run in the background as a daemon, this organiser is one of the best I have ever come across.

An overview

Calcurse can operate in three modes. The first is the non-interactive mode, where you have to pass arguments to the program and get the output on the terminal. The second interactive